

PROJECT DOCUMENT

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

IT Service Management / Flow Designer Project

Project Type: Automation using Flow Designer

Domain: IT Procurement / IT Service Management

Main Objective: Automate standard laptop procurement requests

1. Introduction

IT procurement often involves repetitive tasks such as receiving laptop requests, checking request details, obtaining approval, creating procurement records, and communicating the status to the requester. Manual handling can increase processing time and may lead to inconsistent execution. This project proposes a Flow Designer automation for standard laptop orders so that routine procurement activities can follow a consistent and traceable workflow.

2. Problem Statement

Employees who require a standard laptop may need to submit a request through an IT service portal. When the request is processed manually, the procurement team may have to perform the same sequence of checks and actions for every request. This can cause delays, missed steps, and unnecessary administrative work.

3. Project Objective

The main objectives are to automate standard laptop procurement requests, reduce repetitive manual work, ensure a consistent approval and fulfillment process, improve request visibility, and create a scalable workflow for other standard IT equipment.

4. Scope of the Project

The project focuses on standard laptop orders and the automation of the associated request workflow.

5. Proposed Solution

A Flow Designer workflow is created to automate the standard laptop procurement process. The flow starts when a qualifying request is submitted. It evaluates the request, performs the required actions, routes approval when applicable, and updates the request as procurement progresses.

6. Workflow Process

- Step 1 – Trigger:** Start the flow when a new standard laptop request is submitted.
- Step 2 – Validate Request:** Check requester, laptop type, quantity, and required details.
- Step 3 – Condition:** Determine whether the requested laptop matches standard laptop criteria.
- Step 4 – Approval:** Send the request for approval when required.
- Step 5 – Procurement Action:** Create or update procurement/fulfillment information.
- Step 6 – Notification:** Notify the requester or responsible team about the status.
- Step 7 – Fulfillment:** Proceed with laptop allocation/procurement.
- Step 8 – Completion:** Update the request as completed after fulfillment.

7. Flow Designer Components

Trigger starts the automation. Actions perform tasks such as creating records, updating fields, notifications, or approvals. Conditions control the workflow path. Data Pills pass information between steps. Approval obtains required authorization. Flow Logic controls the sequence and decisions.

8. Example Flow Logic

When a laptop request is submitted → validate request details → check whether the laptop is a standard model → if standard, continue with procurement → request approval if required → create/update fulfillment details → notify requester → complete the request.

9. Benefits

The automation provides faster processing, reduced manual effort, consistent procurement steps, improved tracking and visibility, fewer missed workflow steps, timely notifications, and a reusable automation pattern for other IT procurement items.

10. Testing Plan

Test a valid standard laptop request, incomplete request, non-standard laptop request, approval-required request, rejected approval, and successful fulfillment to verify that each condition and action works correctly.

11. Expected Outcome

The completed solution should provide an automated and consistent process for standard laptop procurement. Routine requests can move through validation, approval, procurement, notification, and completion with minimal manual intervention.

12. Future Enhancements

Possible enhancements include automatic inventory availability checks, procurement/vendor integration, escalation for delayed approvals, procurement dashboards, and extending the workflow to monitors, keyboards, mobile devices, and other standard IT assets.

13. Conclusion

The Streamlining IT Procurement project demonstrates how Flow Designer can automate a repetitive IT procurement process. By standardizing the workflow for laptop orders, the organization can reduce manual effort, improve consistency, increase visibility, and provide a smoother experience for employees and IT teams.